

Assessment	Test	Domain	Skill	Difficulty
SAT	Math	Algebra	Linear inequalities in one or two variables	Hard

Question

Adam’s school is a 20-minute walk or a 5-minute bus ride away from his house. The bus runs once every 30 minutes, and the number of minutes, w , that Adam waits for the bus varies between 0 and 30. Which of the following inequalities gives the values of w for which it would be faster for Adam to walk to school?

Answer

- A. $w - 5 < 20$
- B. $w - 5 > 20$
- C. $w + 5 < 20$
- D. $w + 5 > 20$

Correct Answer: D

Rationale

Choice D is correct. It is given that w is the number of minutes that Adam waits for the bus. The total time it takes Adam to get to school on a day he takes the bus is the sum of the minutes, w , he waits for the bus and the 5 minutes the bus ride takes; thus, this time, in minutes, is $w + 5$. It is also given that the total amount of time it takes Adam to get to school on a day that he walks is 20 minutes. Therefore, $w + 5 > 20$ gives the values of w for which it would be faster for Adam to walk to school.

Choices A and B are incorrect because $w - 5$ is not the total length of time for Adam to wait for and then take the bus to school. Choice C is incorrect because the inequality should be true when walking 20 minutes is faster than the time it takes Adam to wait for and ride the bus, not less.